

Summary of Survey Results

This preliminary analysis examined the perception of 10 respondents on the effects of gasoline expenses in British Columbia. Specifically, it measured the effect on household finances, income, transportation, standard of living, and confidence in government. The sample consisted of seven male and three female respondents, distributed across three age groups: under 30, ages 31-44, and ages 45 and above.

Overall, respondents generally perceived gasoline expenses as affecting their household finances and expenses. Majority of the respondents either agreed or strongly agreed that gasoline expenses affected the amount of money they could save, indicating that savings may be one of the most noticeable areas of financial pressure. Moreover, there was a mixed and somewhat less consistent response on the effects on transportation and income. Although some respondents agreed that gasoline expenses affected their ability to travel where they needed to go, some disagreed on the impact on income. This suggests that gasoline costs may have a clearer effect on household budgets and savings than on income-generating capacity.

The effect on overall standard of living was divided. Some agreed that gasoline expenses affected their household's standard of living, others were either neutral or in disagreement. The same divided effects were seen on the changes in transportation habits by the respondents.

Views of the Government of British Columbia were generally cautious or negative. Respondents disagreed that the provincial government was taking appropriate action in response to gasoline prices. Satisfaction with the government's response was very low, while responses concerning confidence in the government's ability to address cost-of-living concerns were mixed.

In summary, the results suggest that respondents primarily experience gasoline prices through their household finances, savings, and general affordability. Perceptions of government action were less favourable than perceptions of personal financial effects. A larger and more diverse sample, and clearer response coding would be required before drawing conclusions about British Columbians generally.